

TV SHOW

Black Mirror Season 5 Review

★★★★☆ | After the massive success of the innovative, if not unprecedented, *Bandersnatch* - the standalone interactive (choose your own story) episode, Charlie Brooker took up the mantle of creating Season 5 of this technology-driven anthology series. Black Mirror Season 5 featured only 3 episodes, like the original seasons 1 and 2, and housed a star-studded cast. However, while the actors disappointed no one with their stellar, emotionally-driven performances, the storytelling itself was quite lukewarm. The entire premise of Black Mirror is unexpected twists caused by the intersection of human lives and technology that leave you with a sense of doom and despair. Unfortunately, this wasn't present evidently in Season 5, where all three episodes lacked in delivering what some of the series' best episodes like 'San Junipero', 'USS Calister', and 'Nosedive' did.

'Striking Vipers' explored sexual and gender fluidity in the backdrop of a VR game that was capable of making

participants feel real sensations in their body as felt by their game characters. The protagonists, Anthony Mackie (Danny) and Yahya Abdul-Mateen II (Karl) deliver a stimulating performance. The lines between homosexuality and heterosexuality, real-life and virtual life, love, lust and friendship are blurred. The promise is there, but the script does not deliver and leaves viewers wanting much more.

'Smithereens', which is the most fast-paced episode out of the lot, features Andrew Scott and Tophér Grace in prominent roles. The episode has some of the best acting seen in Black Mirror history, however, the story is just disappointing. It explores social media, distracted driving and the feeling of helplessness in the face of the addictiveness of the ever-alluring social media. Andrew Scott plays the role of the grief-stricken man

who has lost a loved one splendidly. However, there is no real gut-puncher in this episode. The episodes in previous seasons have certainly hardened us and *Smithereens* fails to be as emotionally painful as it ought to be.

Rachel, Jack and Ashley Too seems like an intriguing episode on the surface, with an AI replacing the actual pop star, Ashley (Miley Cyrus) when she is struck by adversity dealt by one of her own. It also features a robot miniature of Ashley which has her entire personality loaded onto it, but holds back the real parts (F-words and the works) with a limiter. Without revealing too much, the end of the episode is shrug-worthy and maybe even cheesy. There is no real message and it is more of a thriller-drama rather than a "Black Mirror" episode that delves into technology and human interrelations and their dark consequences.



MOVIE

Men In Black International

★★★★☆ | The cast of Thor Ragnarok all upped and decided to make a Men in Black movie. That's what first came to mind when we watched MIB International. Aside from a few nods and references (there was even one to Thor), MIB International has nothing to do with the previous Men In Black movies. So, you don't have to worry catching up.

Now on to the movie itself, it was pretty meh. The story was lacklustre and



it carried no weight when compared to previous MIB movies. You didn't really have reason to invest yourselves in it, and ultimately, the movie banked on the action, special effects and nostalgia. Which for us, simply wasn't enough. The idea of having a female lead in the Men in Black was pretty good. A few jabs at it being called the "Men" in Black were interspersed here and there. Overdoing it got annoying though.

MIB movies have historically been pretty funny, but they've had a really good plot as well. International overdoes it with the humour and throws the plot away for something that was very predictable right from the start. Overall, it's worth watching just once, just for the nostalgia, and Pawny. Pawny was great.